

OPYPARAPHRASE OF TELEGRAM RECEIVEDCONFIDENTIAL

FROM: AMLEGATION, Bern
TO: Secretary of State, Washington
DATED: October 6, 1943
NUMBER: 6269

In connection with the following message we refer to the Department's cable of September 23, 1943, no. 2373, which transmitted to us Treasury authorization for the Legation to issue to the World Jewish Congress and its agents license to effect currency and other transactions with enemy trusteeship for evacuation of Jewish refugees from France and Roumania, which authorization was given notwithstanding General Baling No. 11. This Legation, pursuant to standing instructions concerning incorporation of transactions with enemy nationals, referred the question of licensing to the British Commercial Secretary who does not concur in the issuance of license in the absence of specific instructions from DEW. The British Commercial Secretary observes that with respect to strong and successful action taken to discourage Jewish ransom, it would be most desirable that we should not be involved in any plans which might result in leakage of funds to the enemy. Opportunity would be afforded by such a scheme for numerous persons in enemy territory who are anxious to convert their own currency into Swiss or other sound currency even if blocked. Experience of the type of adventurer who would undoubtedly participate suggests to me that no means can be devised which would prevent the scheme from giving rise to working out abuses. This is the end of the British Commercial Secretary's observation.

In the absence of specific instructions from the Department, the Legation is uncertain to exercise authority granted by the Treasury to issue licenses to implement the Riegner plan